

LEGISLATURE OF THE STATE OF IDAHO
Sixty-eighth Legislature Second Regular Session - 2026

IN THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES
HOUSE CONCURRENT RESOLUTION NO. 25

BY STATE AFFAIRS COMMITTEE

A CONCURRENT RESOLUTION

STATING FINDINGS OF THE LEGISLATURE AND REQUESTING THAT CONGRESS CALL A CONVENTION FOR PROPOSING AMENDMENTS UNDER ARTICLE V OF THE CONSTITUTION OF THE UNITED STATES LIMITED TO PROPOSING AN AMENDMENT TO THE CONSTITUTION OF THE UNITED STATES REQUIRING THAT, IN THE ABSENCE OF A NATIONAL EMERGENCY, THE TOTAL OF ALL FEDERAL OUTLAYS MADE BY CONGRESS FOR ANY FISCAL YEAR MAY NOT EXCEED THE TOTAL OF ALL ESTIMATED FEDERAL REVENUES FOR THAT FISCAL YEAR, TOGETHER WITH ANY RELATED AND APPROPRIATE FISCAL RESTRAINTS.

Be It Resolved by the Legislature of the State of Idaho:

WHEREAS, the United States Congress has run up a debt so massive that it has endangered the United States government, the United States economy, United States national defense, and all 50 states; and

WHEREAS, Article V of the Constitution of the United States mandates that upon the "Application of the Legislatures of two thirds of the several States" Congress shall "call a Convention for proposing Amendments"; and

WHEREAS, historically when the states have come within one application of the two-thirds of the states, which is 34 out of the 50 states, necessary to call a convention to propose a specific amendment, Congress has acted to propose said amendment in order to prevent a convention from being called; and

WHEREAS, President Ronald Reagan advocated the use of a "thirty-three state strategy" or "preemption" to pressure Congress to propose a balanced budget amendment for ratification by the states; and

WHEREAS, the Legislature deems that an amendment to the Constitution of the United States that would require a balanced federal budget is necessary for the good of the American people.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the members of the Second Regular Session of the Sixty-eighth Idaho Legislature, the House of Representatives and the Senate concurring therein, that the Idaho Legislature applies to Congress, under the provisions of Article V of the Constitution of the United States, for the calling of a convention of the states limited to proposing an amendment to the Constitution of the United States requiring that, in the absence of a national emergency, the total of all federal outlays made by Congress for any fiscal year may not exceed the total of all estimated federal revenues for that fiscal year, together with any related and appropriate fiscal restraints.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that copies of this application must be transmitted to the President of the United States, the Secretary of the United States Senate, the Speaker and Clerk of the United States House of Representatives, and the members of the United States Senate and the United States House of Representatives from this state.

1 BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that copies of this application must also be
2 transmitted to the presiding officers of each of the legislative houses in
3 the several states, requesting their cooperation in this endeavor.

4 BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that this application constitutes a continuing
5 application in accordance with Article V of the Constitution of the United
6 States until the legislatures of at least two-thirds of the several states
7 have made applications on the same subject, or until December 31, 2033,
8 whichever occurs earlier. It supersedes all previous applications by this
9 legislature on the same subject.